

Tax & Depreciation Essentials Checklist — Investors (Queensland)

What to have in place, and what's changing, before you lodge your next return.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only — this is NOT financial, tax or legal advice. Always engage a qualified accountant or tax agent for advice specific to your situation.

Section 1 — Records to Keep From Day One

- ☐ [] **A tax depreciation schedule from a qualified quantity surveyor** — Division 43 (building) and Division 40 (plant and equipment) deductions.
- ☐ [] **Receipts for repairs vs. improvements — kept separately.** Repairs are often immediately deductible; improvements form part of your CGT cost base instead.
- ☐ [] **Queensland Revenue Office land tax assessments** — keep every annual assessment.
- ☐ [] **Transfer duty and AFAD receipts**, if applicable.
- ☐ [] **Records of your accountant fees and depreciation schedule costs.**

Section 2 — Queensland Land Tax Obligations

- ☐ [] **Check whether you're above the threshold.** Land tax applies where your taxable Queensland land value reaches **\$600,000 for individuals**, or **\$350,000 for companies and trustees**.
- ☐ [] **Understand land tax is assessed against your total Queensland landholdings**, not property-by-property — owning several properties with lower individual values can still bring you over the threshold in combination.
- ☐ [] **Know the assessment date.** Queensland land tax locks in based on your holdings as at **30 June** each year.
- ☐ [] **If you're an absentee owner, budget for the surcharge** — currently **3%** (increased from an original 2%) on the value above the relevant threshold.
- ☐ [] **If you're a foreign entity, understand the land tax foreign surcharge (LTFS) is separate from AFAD** — AFAD is a one-off duty at purchase (7%), while LTFS is an ongoing annual land tax surcharge. Both can apply to the same investor.
- ☐ [] **Check the new foreign surcharge exemption framework if relevant.** From 30 June 2026, Queensland replaced its previous ex gratia relief system with new administrative exemption rulings for genuine commercial contributors and large residential developers — this generally does **not** extend to passive landlords/investors, so don't assume relief applies without checking your specific circumstances.

Section 3 — Understanding the Changing CGT Environment

- ☐ [] **Be aware Commonwealth CGT settings for investment property are changing**, with reforms affecting the CGT discount generally applying from **1 July 2027** — confirm the finalised, current rules with your accountant.
- ☐ [] **If planning to sell, get advice on timing relative to the 2027 changeover** — the impact depends heavily on your specific purchase price, holding period, and expected gain.

Section 4 — Depreciation Schedule Timing

- ☐ [] **Get your depreciation schedule prepared as early as possible after settlement.**
- ☐ [] **Update it after any renovations or major asset additions.**
- ☐ [] **Don't assume an older Queensland property has no deductions available** — plant and equipment deductions can still apply, and given Queensland's climate, items like air conditioning and ceiling fans are often significant depreciable assets worth confirming with your quantity surveyor.

Section 5 — Questions to Bring to Your Accountant

- ☐ [] What is my current Queensland land tax position across all my Queensland landholdings combined?
- ☐ [] Does the absentee owner surcharge or the foreign surcharge apply to me, and have the 2026 relief framework changes affected my position?
- ☐ [] How will the 2027 CGT changes affect a future sale of this property, given my purchase price and expected holding period?
- ☐ [] Is my depreciation schedule up to date with any renovations or asset purchases since it was last prepared?

Quick Reference — QLD Investor Tax Snapshot (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Land tax threshold (individuals)	\$600,000
Land tax threshold (companies/trusts)	\$350,000
Absentee owner surcharge	3%
Additional Foreign Acquirer Duty (AFAD)	7%, one-off at purchase
Land tax foreign surcharge	Separate ongoing annual surcharge; new exemption framework from 30 June 2026
Land tax assessment date	30 June each year

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